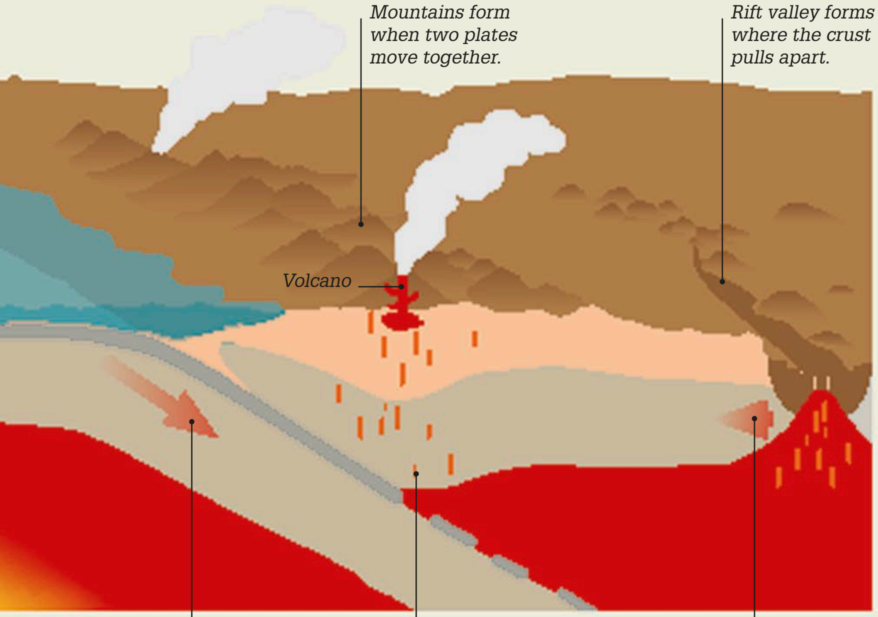
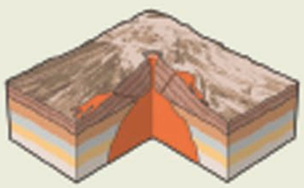
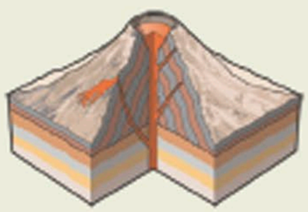


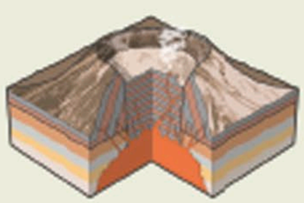
Types of volcano
Volcanoes are of different shapes and sizes, depending on the kind of magma that erupts from them, how fast the lava cools, the shape of their vents, and the type of eruption (explosive or nonexplosive). There are four main types of volcano—shield volcano, stratovolcano, caldera volcano, and cinder cone.



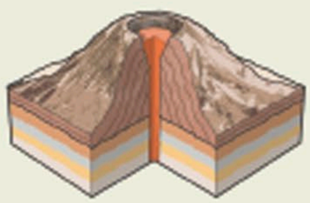
Shield volcano
In a shield volcano, fast-moving, runny lava flows steadily to form a broad, gently sloping volcano.



Stratovolcano
Stratovolcanoes are produced when the lava cools and hardens quickly, forming steep sides.



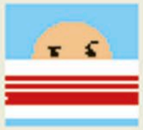
Caldera
A caldera is a huge cauldron-shaped crater. It is created when the walls of a stratovolcano partly collapse.



Cinder cone
Cone-shaped volcanoes form when magma erupts from a single vent, building up layers of lava and ash.

Richter scale

The best known method for measuring the magnitude (size) of an earthquake is the Richter scale. The amount of ground motion caused by an earthquake is measured using an increasing number scale, with 1 as the weakest.



1.0 Almost undetectable
Tiny tremors are felt deep underground. They can be detected by seismographs, but not usually by people.

2.0 Tremors felt
People may notice the shaking, especially if they are sitting still on the upper floors of buildings.

3.0 Objects swing
The shaking becomes more obvious although it may not be recognizable as an earthquake. Hanging objects start to swing.

4.0 Trees shake
People indoors feel vibrations like the passing of a large truck in front of the house. Trees sway and windows rattle.

5.0 Water spills
Liquid may spill from glasses. Some windows may break and doors swing open. People may start to fall over outside.

6.0 Walls crack
It can be difficult to stand up during a 6.0 earthquake. Walls may crack, and tiles may fall from roofs.

7.0 Houses shake
A size 7.0 earthquake may cause considerable damage. Houses may shake on their foundations and roads crack.

8.0 Buildings collapse
Buildings and bridges start to collapse. Other damage may include burst pipes, twisted railroads, and landslides.

9.0 and above Destruction
Huge cracks appear in the ground causing the total destruction of all buildings and resulting in a large loss of life.